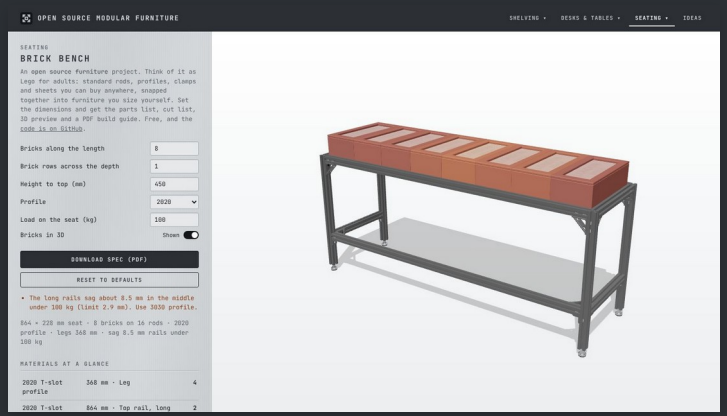
OPEN SOURCE MODULAR FURNITURE

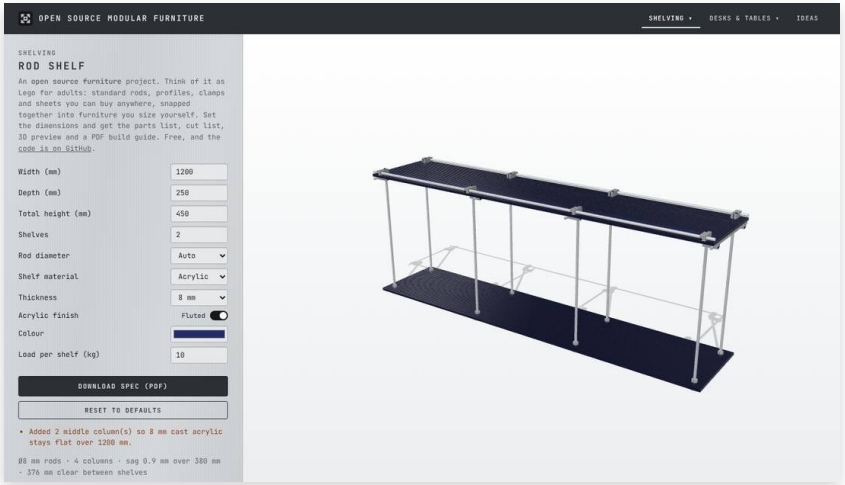
DESIGN FURNITURE WITH US

How to contribute to Open Source Modular Furniture with the Claude desktop app. No coding needed: you design, Claude builds.

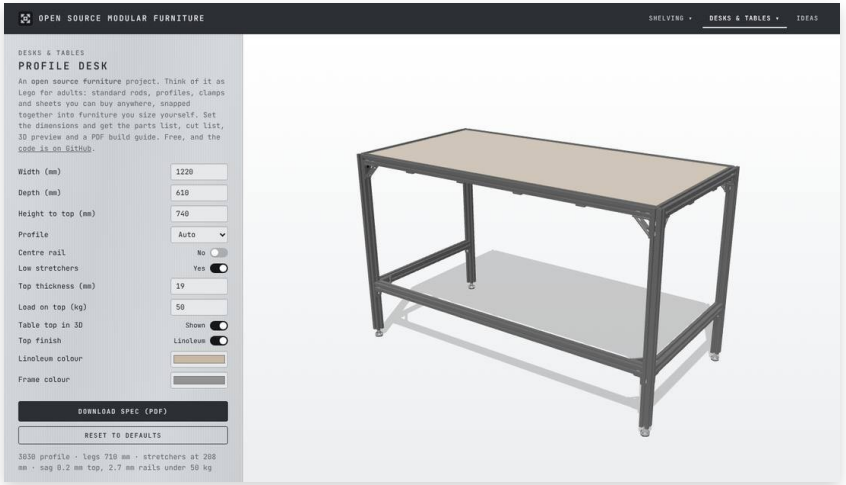


LEGO FOR ADULTS, SIZED BY ANYONE

Standard parts you can buy anywhere, snapped together into furniture people size themselves. Each piece is a page on the site, picked from the top menu: a configurator.



Rod shelf: chrome rods, cross clamps, acrylic or wood sheets



Profile desk: T-slot aluminium, brackets, plywood top

THE GOAL: TRY IT FIRST

1

See it
Claude runs a private copy of the site on your computer. Not the real one.

2

Try it
Open it in your browser and use it like a visitor would.

3

Improve it
Tell Claude what to change, in plain words. Refresh, look again.

4

Send it
When you're happy, Claude sends your change to the owner for review.

↻ **Repeat 2 and 3 as often as you like**

This private copy is a "non-production" version: production is the real site everyone uses.

YOU DESIGN, CLAUDE BUILDS

You, the designer

- What the piece is and how it looks
- Which real parts to buy, and their sizes
- How it goes together, step by step
- What people can change, and the limits
- Saying "yes, that looks right" or "move this"

Claude, in the desktop app

- Runs the private copy of the site for you
- Writes the code and the tests
- Shows you what changed after every round
- Saves versions as it goes
- Sends your change for review

BEFORE YOU START, ONCE

1

A GitHub account

Free, at github.com/signup. GitHub is where the project lives.

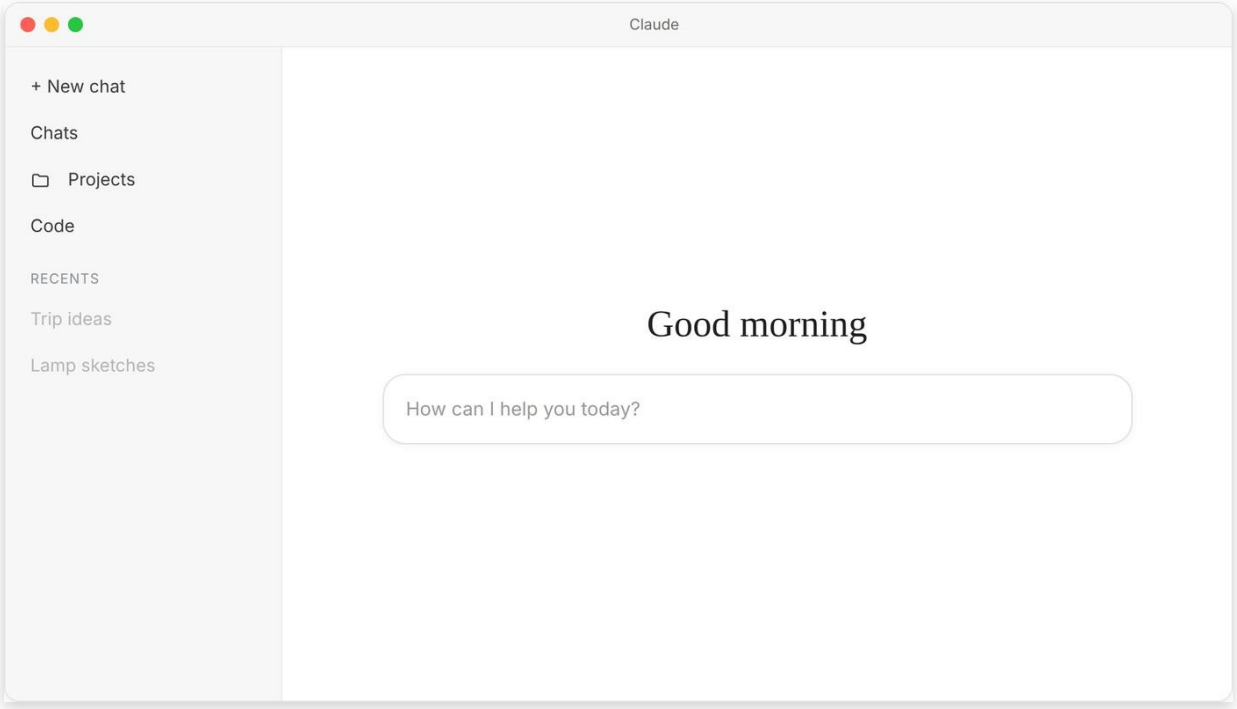
2

The Claude desktop app

Download it from claude.ai/download, install it and sign in.

That's all the setup. Everything else (downloading the project, running the site, your own copy on GitHub) is prepared, and Claude does it for you.

STEP 0: OPEN THE CLAUDE APP

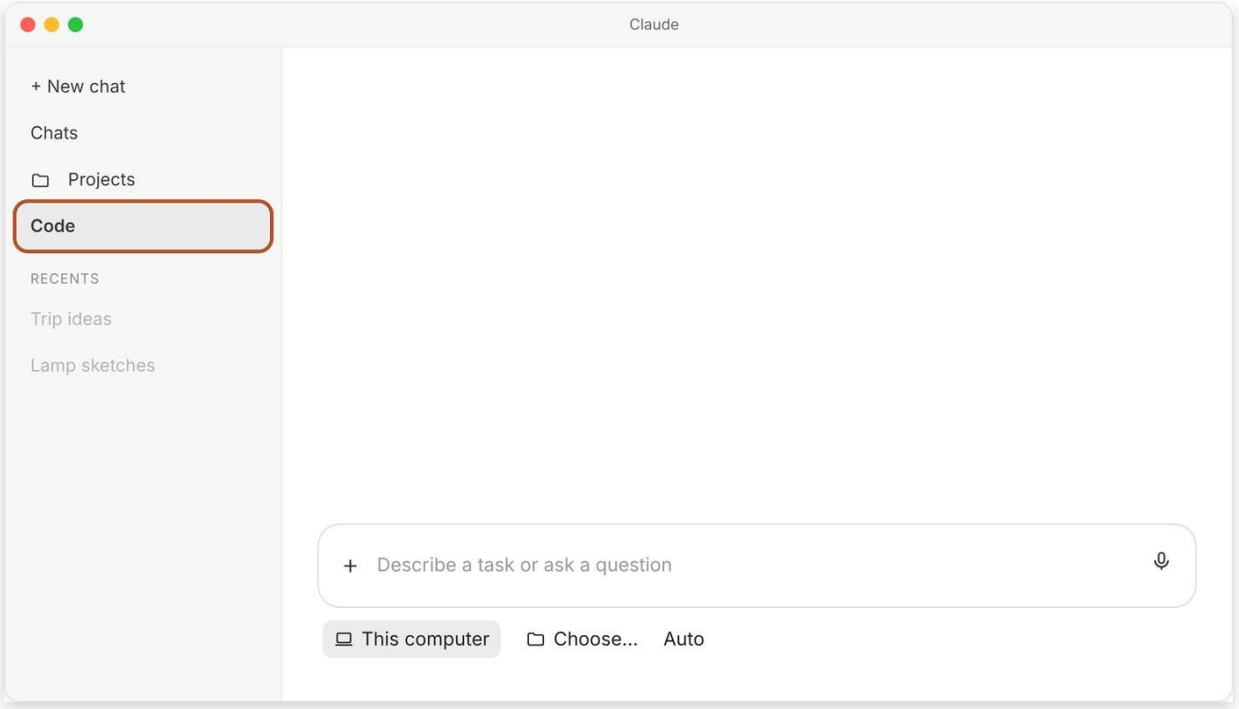


0

Open Claude

Open the Claude desktop app from your Applications (Mac) or Start menu (Windows), and sign in if asked.

STEP 1: GO TO CODE

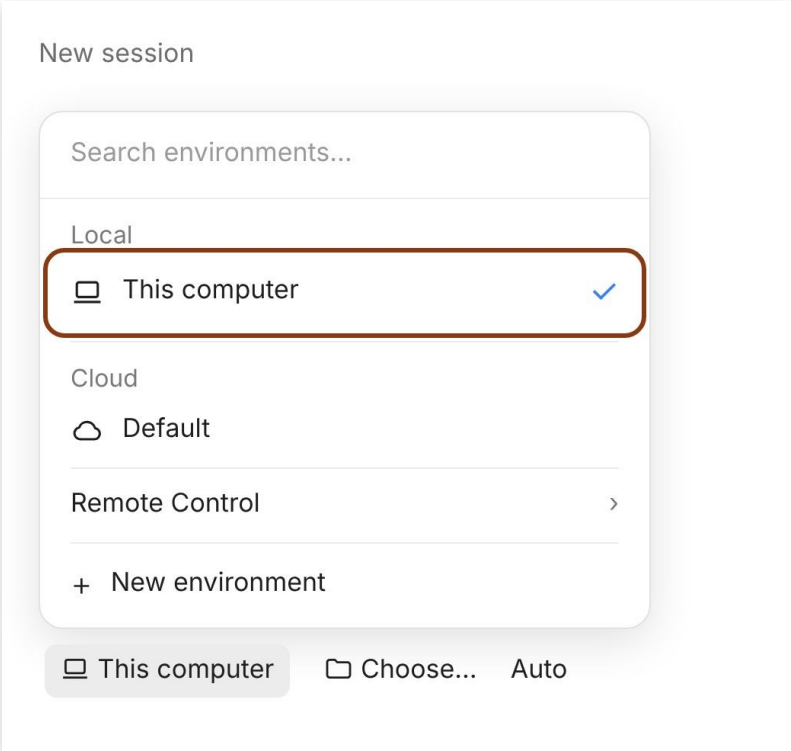


1

Click Code

In the left sidebar, click Code. This is the part of the app that works on projects, not just chats.

STEP 2: PICK "THIS COMPUTER"



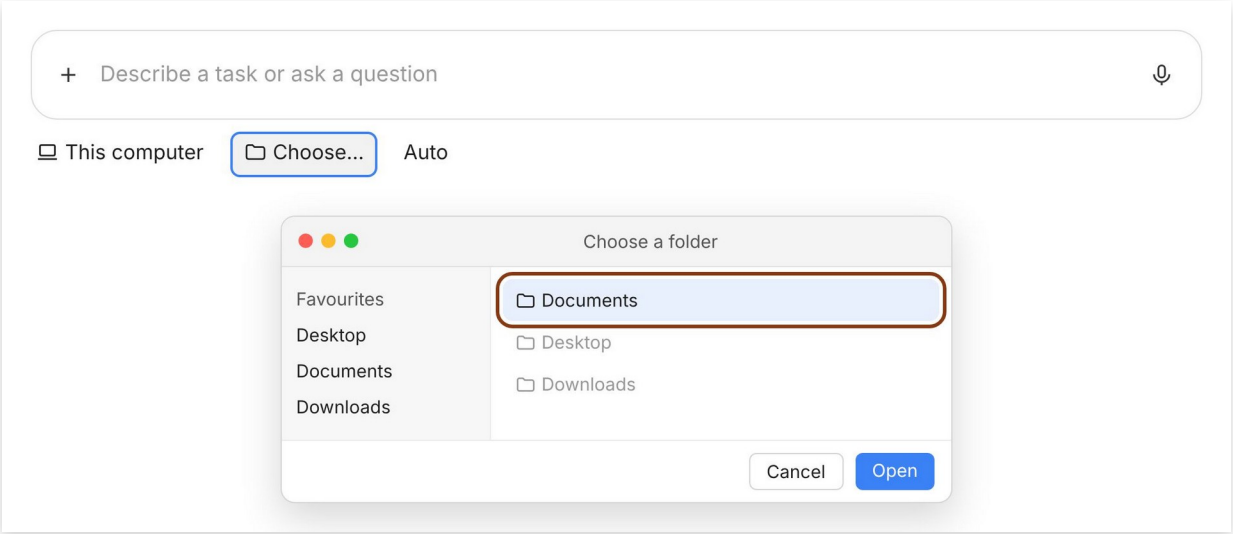
2

Click the first button under the message box
It opens the menu on the left.

Choose "This computer", under Local
Claude then works on your computer, so the site opens in your own browser.

Not "Default", under Cloud
That runs on Anthropic's computers, and the site would not open in your browser.

THEN CHOOSE… A FOLDER

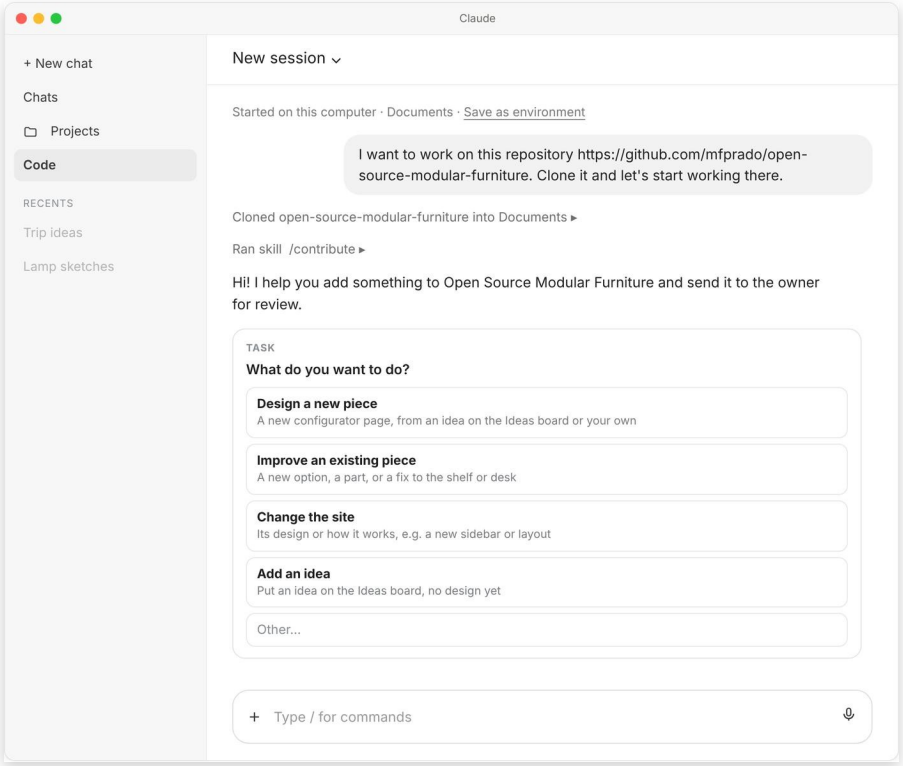


2

Pick where to keep it

Click Choose… (next to This computer). A window opens: pick the folder where you want to keep the project, for example Documents. Claude will put the project folder there.

STEP 3: TELL CLAUDE THE PROJECT

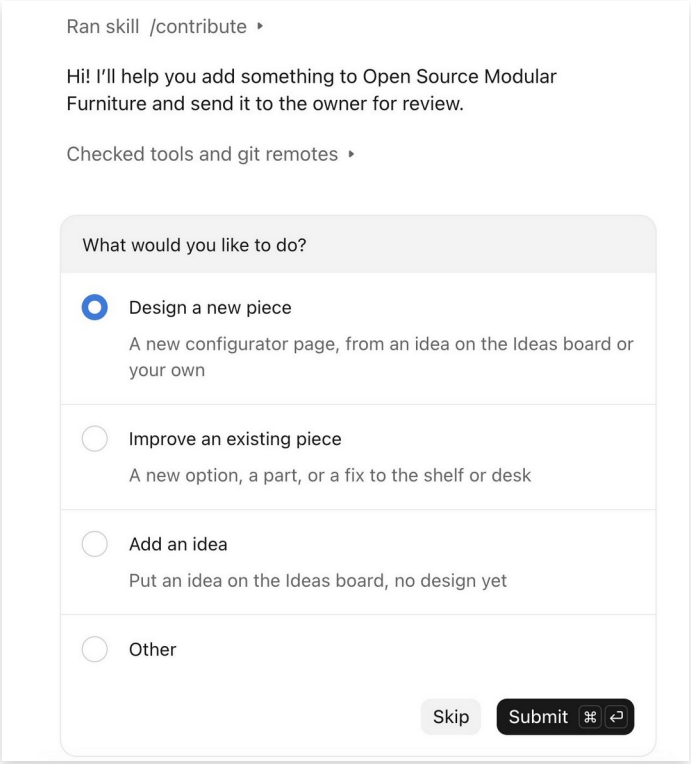


3

Paste this

"I want to work on this repository https://github.com/mfprado/open-source-modular-furniture. Clone it and let's start working there."

STEP 4: CLAUDE TAKES IT FROM THERE

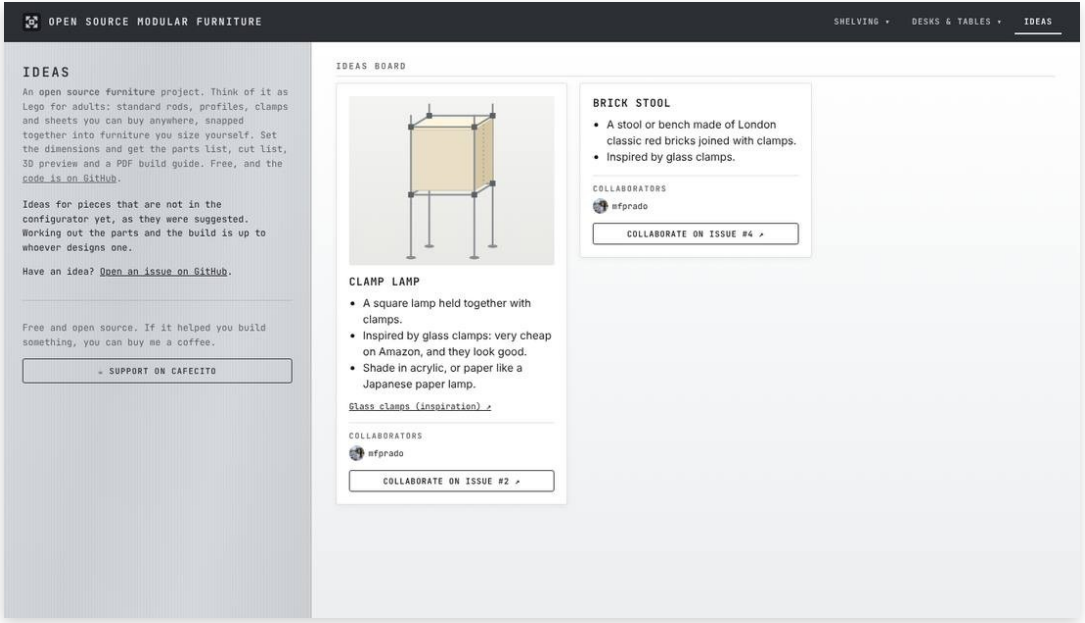


Everything is prepared
The project carries step-by-step instructions for Claude ("Ran skill /contribute"), so it knows how to guide you.

Click your answers
Claude asks with buttons. Pick one and click Submit, or choose Other and type your own.

It starts your private copy
And opens it for you.

NOT SURE WHAT TO MAKE?



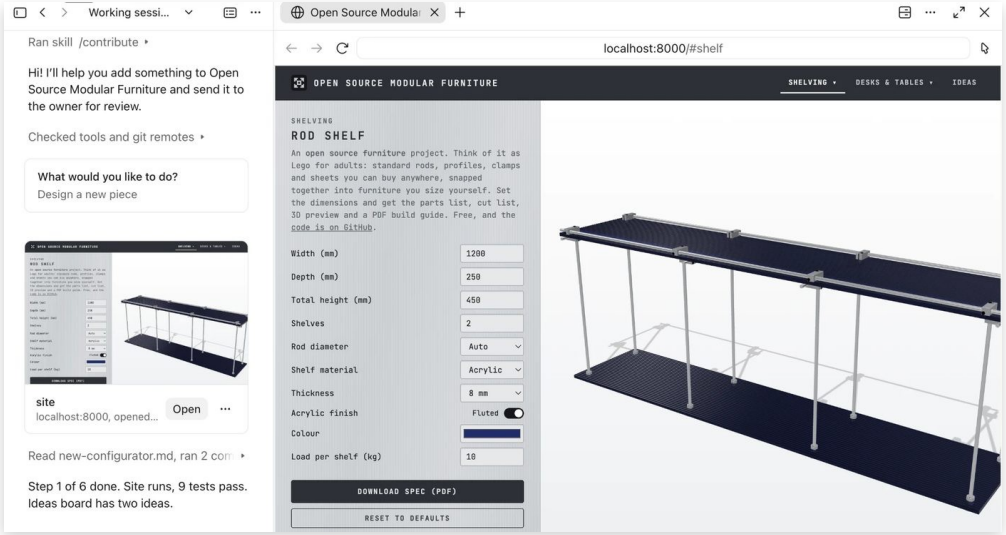
The Ideas page (top bar, right) lists pieces nobody has designed yet, each with an open GitHub issue.

Pick one, or bring your own.

Tell Claude which one; it reads the issue and its pictures.

The real example in this guide: the Brick stool (idea #4) became the Brick bench.

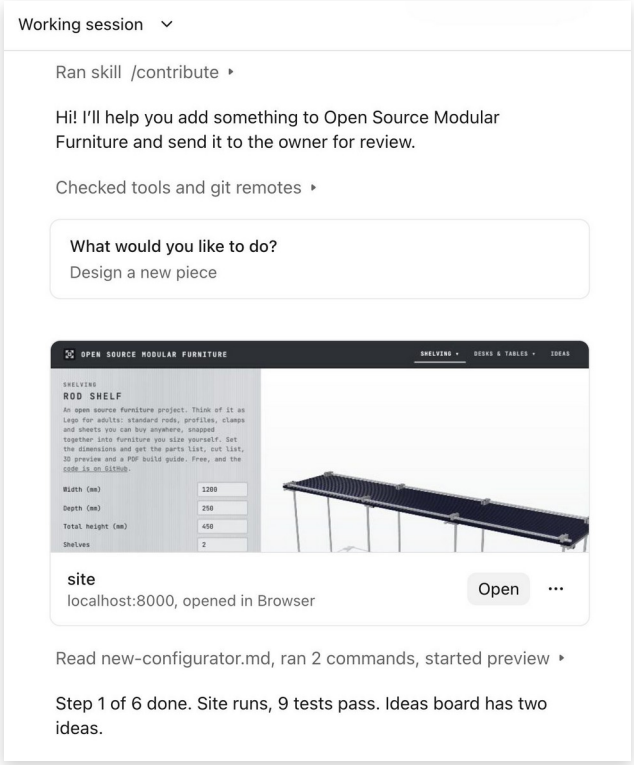
YOUR PRIVATE COPY, NEXT TO THE CHAT



The real site `mfprado.github.io/…`
Production: everyone sees it. It only changes after the owner approves.

Your private copy `localhost:8000`
Non-production: only on your computer, and it shows your changes straight away.

WHERE TO LOOK AT IT



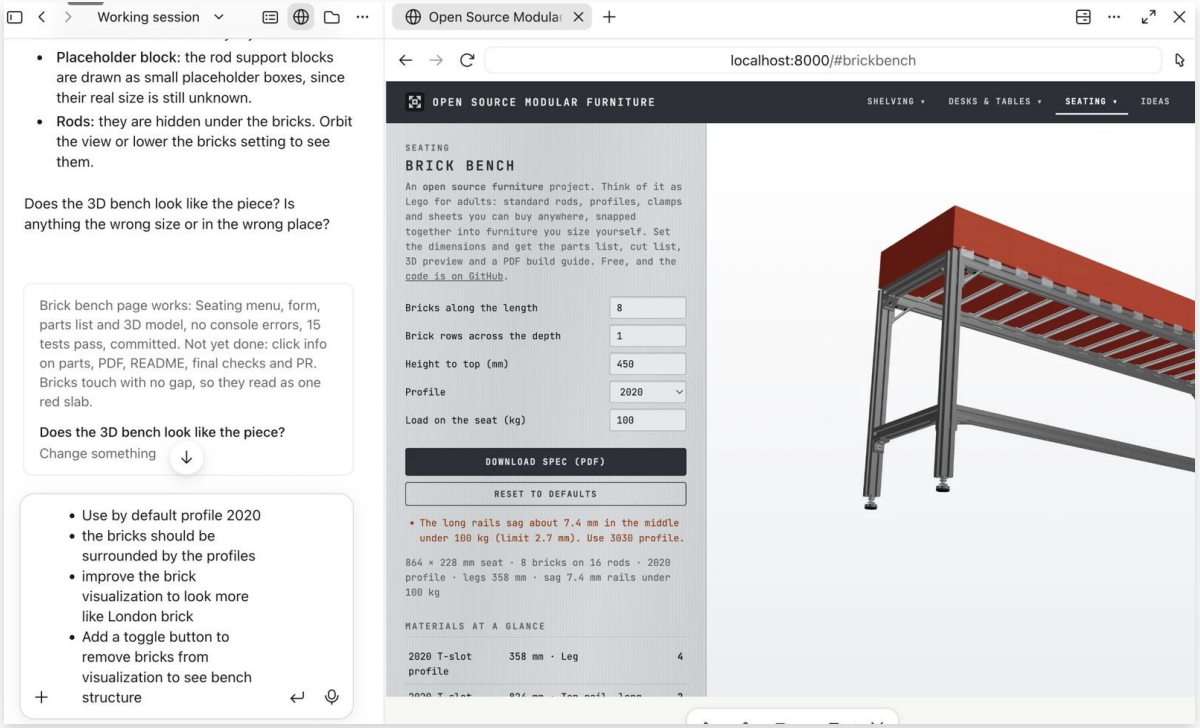
1. **Click the link Claude sends**
   Like localhost:8000/#brickbench. It opens the page next to the chat, up to date.

2. **Or the site card**
   Click Open on the card in the chat. The same link also works in Chrome.

3. **After each change**
   Claude sends the link again, or press the ↻ refresh button.

"This site can't be reached"? The copy is switched off. Ask Claude to start the site again.

WORK IN ROUNDS: CHAT, LOOK, REPEAT



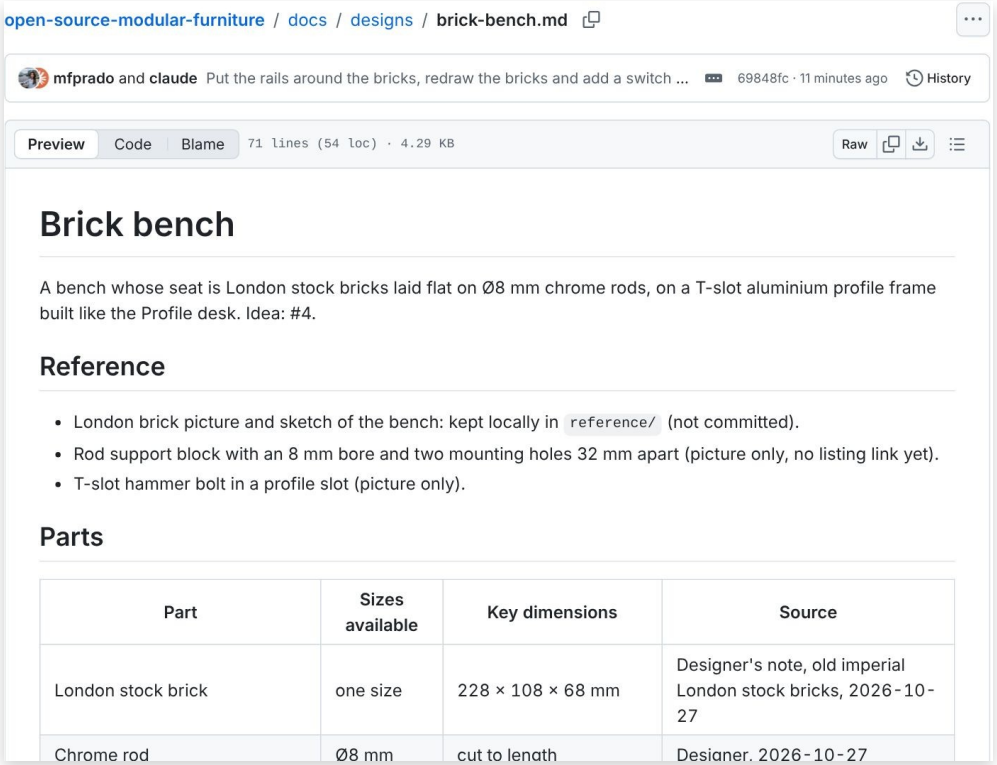
Claude makes one change
And asks if it looks right.

You look at it, right there
Orbit the 3D view, change the settings, read the parts list.

You say what to change
In plain words, as a list if you like. Claude does the next round.

Each round is saved, so nothing is lost if you change your mind.

NEW PIECE? IT STARTS WITH A BRIEF



open-source-modular-furniture / docs / designs / brick-bench.md

mfprado and claude Put the rails around the bricks, redraw the bricks and add a switch ... 69848fc · 11 minutes ago History

Preview Code Blame 71 lines (54 loc) · 4.29 KB Raw

Brick bench

A bench whose seat is London stock bricks laid flat on Ø8 mm chrome rods, on a T-slot aluminium profile frame built like the Profile desk. Idea: #4.

Reference

- London brick picture and sketch of the bench: kept locally in `reference/` (not committed).
- Rod support block with an 8 mm bore and two mounting holes 32 mm apart (picture only, no listing link yet).
- T-slot hammer bolt in a profile slot (picture only).

Parts

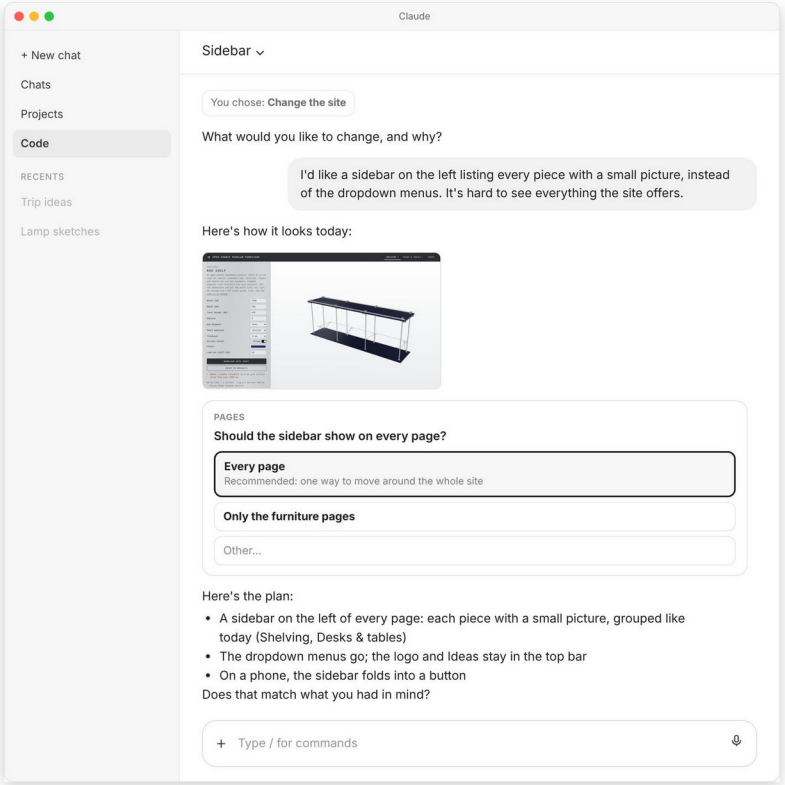
Part	Sizes available	Key dimensions	Source
London stock brick	one size	228 × 108 × 68 mm	Designer's note, old imperial London stock bricks, 2026-10-27
Chrome rod	Ø8 mm	cut to length	Designer, 2026-10-27

An interview first
Claude asks one topic at a time: pictures, parts, how it goes together, what people can change.

Written down as a brief
docs/designs/brick-bench.md: parts and sources, settings, rules, warnings, assembly.

Unknown means unknown
The rod support block's sizes went on a "to measure" list instead of a guess.

CHANGING THE SITE? SHOW WHAT YOU MEAN



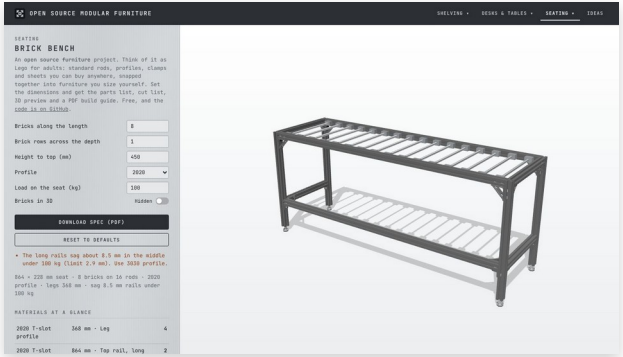
Say what and why
For example a sidebar listing every piece, because the menus hide what the site offers.

Share a picture if you have one
A sketch, a site you like, or a marked-up screenshot.

Agree a short plan
Claude shows the site today, asks a question or two, and sums up the change before building it.

BEFORE SENDING: TRY IT ALL

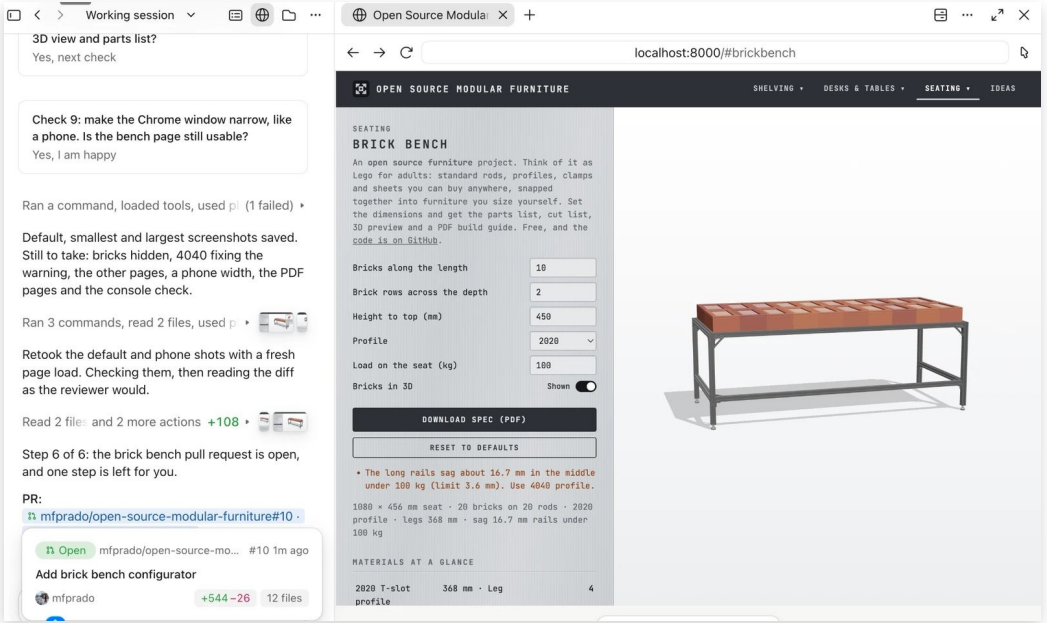
- ✔ Smallest and largest sizes
- ✔ Each option on and off
- ✔ Make each warning appear
- ✔ Click parts in the 3D view
- ✔ Find it in the top menu
- ✔ Download and read the PDF
- ✔ Shelf and desk still work
- ✔ Narrow window, like a phone



Real example: the Brick bench with Bricks in 3D hidden, and its sag warning

Found something odd? Tell Claude, refresh, check again.
Then Claude runs its own checks and takes the screenshots for the owner.

LAST STEP: SEND IT AS A PULL REQUEST

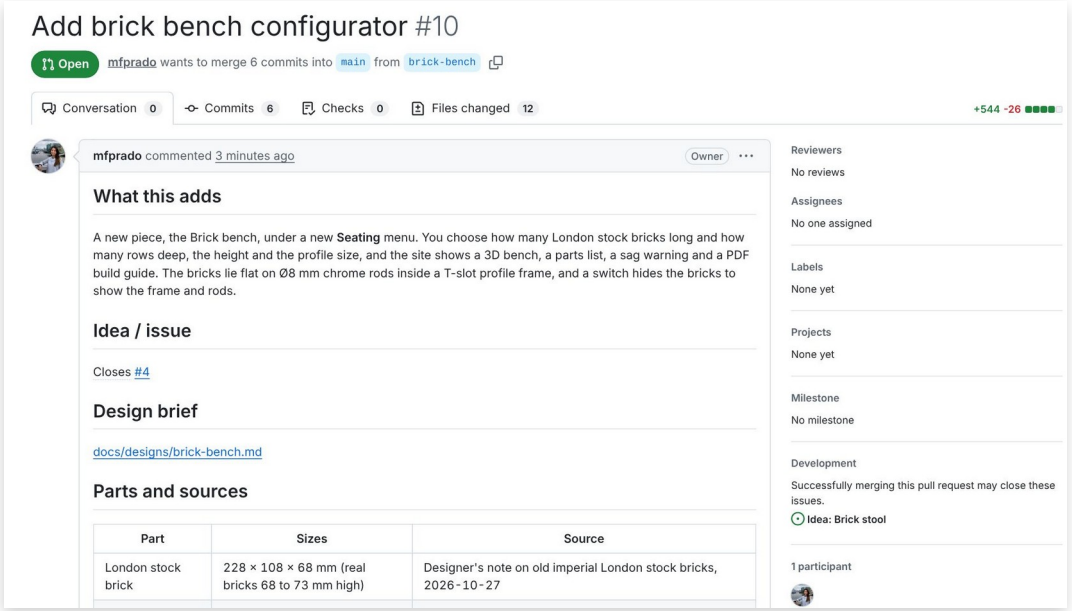


A pull request (PR) is your proposed change. It holds the change, a description of it, and evidence of the proposed new version: screenshots and notes. The owner reviews it, and only once they approve does it reach the real site.

When you say "I'm happy", Claude runs its own checks, takes the screenshots and opens the PR, here "Add brick bench configurator" (#10).

Your one job: drag the screenshots into it on GitHub.

AFTER YOU SEND IT



Add brick bench configurator #10

Open mfprado wants to merge 6 commits into main from brick-bench

Conversation 0 · Commits 6 · Checks 0 · Files changed 12 · +544 -26

mfprado commented 3 minutes ago · Owner

What this adds

A new piece, the Brick bench, under a new **Seating** menu. You choose how many London stock bricks long and how many rows deep, the height and the profile size, and the site shows a 3D bench, a parts list, a sag warning and a PDF build guide. The bricks lie flat on Ø8 mm chrome rods inside a T-slot profile frame, and a switch hides the bricks to show the frame and rods.

Idea / issue

Closes #4

Design brief

docs/designs/brick-bench.md

Parts and sources

Part	Sizes	Source
London stock brick	228 × 108 × 68 mm (real bricks 68 to 73 mm high)	Designer's note on old imperial London stock bricks, 2026-10-27

Reviewers: No reviews

Assignees: No one assigned

Labels: None yet

Projects: None yet

Milestone: No milestone

Development: Successfully merging this pull request may close these issues. Idea: Brick stool

1 participant

1 Owner reviews
Starting with the brief and the screenshots

2 Comments
Questions or changes, on GitHub

3 Ask Claude
"let's work on the review comments"

4 Merged
Your piece is live on the site

Changes go on the same pull request: open Code again (This computer, the project folder), and Claude picks up the comments.

OPEN SOURCE MODULAR FURNITURE

THREE THINGS TO SAY

Claude app → Code → This computer → Choose… (where to keep it the first time, then the project folder):

```
"I want to work on
github.com/mfprado/open-source-
modular-furniture. Clone it and
let's start"
```

```
"let's work on this" (next times)
```

```
"I'm happy, let's send it"
```